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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (Honours)/MGU-BBA (Honours)/MGU-BCA (Honours) Special Examinations, July 2026

(for 2024 Admission Regular Examinations, October 2025)

Third Semester

Discipline Specific Elective (DSE) - MG3DSEENG201 - READING CULTURE: FOOD, TRAVEL AND MUSIC

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 Hours Maximum Marks: 70

Scheme of Valuation

Part A - MCQ

Answer all questions. Each question carries 1 mark

1. c) He should fill the heart of his clients (CO1)
2. d) Someone who left Lahore due to Partition (CO1)
3. d) Divine light and goodness (CO2)
4. b) T. M. Krishna (CO2)
5. c) Cultural and emotional sustenance (CO3)
6. a) Streets of Port-au-Prince in Haiti (CO3)
7. a) Satirise the irrational customs of European society (CO4)
8. c) 40 feet square (CO4)
9. b) A mourning of separation from Calcutta (CO4)
10. b) Rationalism and practical knowledge (CO4)

[1x10 = 10]

Part B - SHORT ANSWER

Answer any 6 questions. Each question carries 5 marks

11. Abhay's emotional manipulation of Tara through chocolates - Tara puts on weight- his body shaming and control - concealment of his affair - Tara's psychological reversal through food - she signs up for a cooking class, makes delectable dishes, has an affair with one of his friends, conceives and has a baby- manipulation of Abhay leading to revenge and empowerment. (CO1)

12. Food is shown as an expression of love and compassion - feeding is meant to touch people's hearts, not merely satisfy hunger - serving the poor is presented as an act of dignity and humanity - hospitality is measured by empathy rather than luxury or profit - Kareem's philosophy transforms Faizi's understanding of cooking and the purpose of life. (CO1)

13. Repetition of rhetorical questions emphasises the persistence of war, injustice, discrimination and human suffering - the repeated refrain "The answer is blowin' in the wind" suggests that the answers remain elusive or ignored - reinforces the song's protest against social injustice - prompts the listener to reflect on human responsibility. (CO2)

14. Rajyashri Goody uses the recipe form to narrate Laxman Gaikwad's experiences of hunger - the "ingredients" reflect poverty, caste oppression and deprivation rather than food - the irony of the recipe format highlights the absence of nourishment - hunger is presented as a social and systemic reality rather than an individual experience. (CO1)

15. Nicolo and Maffeo Polo sailed from Constantinople to Soldaia and purchased fine and costly jewels - travelled to the court of Barka, the ruler of the Western Tartars, where they presented the jewels and were generously rewarded - unable to return because of the war between Barka and Alaù - continued eastward and reached Bokhara, where they remained for three years. (CO3)

16. Kublai Khan warmly welcomed Nicolo Polo and Maffeo Polo and later received Marco Polo into his service - unlike many Eastern rulers, he trusted capable foreigners and appointed them to important administrative and diplomatic duties - he valued merit and loyalty over nationality - his openness enabled the Polos to enjoy his patronage and serve in his court. (CO3)

17. Music in India was being consumed through Walkmans, cassettes and CDs - music acquired a much wider reach - listening was becoming a private experience through headphones and cassette players - music was no longer viewed merely as part of films but as an independent entity - the changing pattern of consumption created a demand for richer and better sound quality. (CO4)

18. In 1970s Rhode Island, Indian groceries were next to impossible to come by - The narrator’s family brought food and ingredients from Calcutta in suitcases. (CO4)

19. Yodha was not the box-office phenomenon that Roja was, but it has since become a cult classic. The film’s soundtrack was received well at the time, but was by no means a massive hit. The movie just wasn’t commercial enough for that and music wasn’t a big part of the film. (CO4)

[5x6 = 30]

Part C - ESSAY

Answer any 2 questions. Each question carries 15 marks

20. Children from oppressed castes are excluded even during recess - caste prejudice continues through separate eating and social exclusion - discrimination is presented as something learned and practised from childhood - the poem exposes how the school reproduces caste inequalities instead of promoting equality. (CO1)

21. The song presents the speaker Taylor Swift as an anti-hero, admitting personal flaws and insecurities instead of projecting perfection - it challenges the idealized image (bodily and otherwise) expected of celebrities - highlights constant public judgement and self-criticism - the song suggests that fame does not remove anxiety, guilt or vulnerability, thus providing an effective commentary on celebrity culture and human imperfection. (CO2)

22. Theroux describes a wide variety of fellow passengers through vivid character sketches -physical appearance and mannerisms- Duffill appears frail, shabby and mysterious, while Molesworth is portrayed as a witty, wine-loving actor's agent with a military bearing - he also notices the unusually tall Belgian girl, the suspicious French mother, the anxious American couple and other eccentric travellers - these detailed, humorous and ironic observations reveal his travel writing as keenly observant, character-centered and rich in social satire. (CO3)

23. The Lilliputian cavalry and infantry performed military drills and formations between them. Gulliver stood with his legs apart while the Lilliputian cavalry and infantry marched safely between them as part of a mock military exercise - he remained perfectly still and followed the Emperor's instructions with great care - the display demonstrated his obedience, self-control and harmless intentions - by cooperating fully with the Emperor, Gulliver strengthened the Emperor's confidence in him and earned greater trust and favour. (CO4)

[15x2 = 30]